

Ecozones of Canada

Lesson Objectives

- Explore the Canadian Ecosystem framework.
- Focus on the Ecozones of Canada.
- Learn about the physical biological and human make-up of the terrestrial and marine Ecozones.
- Learn about raster data and how it is used.
- Produce both raster and vector maps showing the Ecozones and some of their characteristics.
- Explore the use of table and chart data.
- Importing and re-coding data
- Geo-referencing
- Map over-laying
- Projections
- Map classification

Curriculum Expectations

The Ontario grade 9 curriculum expectations were used as a basis for preparing the lessons in this series. Although there is no direct correlation between Ontario expectations and other provinces, in general, the issues covered in the lessons do relate to many of the curriculum requirements in other jurisdictions. The full curriculum expectations can be found at the Ontario Ministry of Education Web site

English: <http://www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/document/curricul/secondary/canadian/canaful.html>

French: <http://www.edu.gov.on.ca/fre/document/curricul/secondary/canadian/canaful.html>

The performance tasks for Grade 9 Academic were based directly on curriculum expectations selected from the policy document for Canadian and world studies. The tasks encompassed the four categories of knowledge and skills (i.e., Knowledge/Understanding, Thinking/Inquiry, Communication, and Application), requiring students to integrate their knowledge and skills in meaningful learning experiences.

The rubric for a specific performance task is intended to provide teachers and students with an overview of the expected final product with regard to the knowledge and skills being assessed as a whole. The rubric identifies key criteria by which students' work is to be assessed, and it provides descriptions that indicate the degree to which the key criteria have been met. The teacher uses the descriptions of the different levels of achievement given in the rubric to assess student achievement on a particular task.